

Nicholas Kadunce

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PLANT MANAGER

PLANT LEADERSHIP · PROCESS & PERFORMANCE OPTIMIZATION · KPI SYSTEMS · HIGH-PERFORMING TEAMS

Operations leader with a proven arc from process engineer to plant manager in five years—now leading a high-volume manufacturing site with full P&L accountability. Builds high-performing teams and the operating discipline—daily management, real-time data, planned maintenance, quality governance—that makes performance repeatable. Measurable results across four manufacturers: 36.7% plant output growth, 340% production rate increase, 66% rework reduction, and \$1M+ annual revenue added. Deploys automation and AI where they eliminate manual work and sharpen decisions.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Leadership & Team Development: High-Performance Team Building · Change Leadership · Talent Development & Coaching · Supervisor Standard Work · Engagement & Retention · Cross-Functional Leadership

Operational Excellence: P&L Accountability · Safety & Quality Systems (ISO 9001) · Risk Management & Mitigation · CMMS & Planned Maintenance · Supplier & Inventory Management

Continuous Improvement: Lean & Six Sigma (Black Belt) · Manufacturing Optimization · Root Cause Analysis · SPC & Pareto Analytics · Visual Management & 5S

Strategy, Financials & Digital Tools: KPI Development & Daily Management · Financial Forecasting & Modeling · Production Scalability · Data-Driven Decision Making · AI-Enabled Reporting & Automation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

JENNMAR — Reedsville, WV

2025 – Present

Plant Manager — Underground Mining & Tunneling Infrastructure Solutions

SCOPE: FULL P&L · ~100 EMPLOYEES · 16 PRODUCTION ASSETS · SAFETY · QUALITY · DELIVERY · COST

Accountable for end-to-end plant performance. Rebuilt the operating cadence around daily management, planned maintenance, and quality governance—installing the data systems and front-line leadership that make results repeatable.

- ▶ Increased plant output **36.7%** in year one by redesigning the operating cadence around a Daily Operations Dashboard—hour-by-hour tracking, downtime Pareto analysis, and statistically derived targets.
- ▶ Built a rolling-average Financial Forecaster generating daily operating-income projections—strengthening financial oversight, streamlining consolidation, and enabling faster executive decisions.
- ▶ Installed a cross-functional daily management system—an automated Operations Performance Summary aligning production, maintenance, quality, and safety on prior-day results each morning.
- ▶ Led the shift from reactive to planned maintenance by implementing FIIX CMMS—disciplined work orders, spares control, and a Maintenance Analytics Dashboard tracking labor hours and work-order volume by asset.
- ▶ Established quality governance with automated SPC and Pareto defect analytics plus a tagged, barriered quarantine zone—ensuring full traceability of hold/rework material and earlier trend detection.
- ▶ Developed front-line leaders through structured Supervisor Standard Work and automated incentive-pay administration—raising accountability while saving hours of indirect labor weekly.
- ▶ Digitized the plant floor with real-time machine monitoring across 16 assets (2.8M+ sensor records) and automated daily performance reporting—eliminating manual data entry so leaders act on data rather than assemble it.

EOS ENERGY ENTERPRISES — Turtle Creek, PA

2023 – 2025

Operations Manager — Battery Energy Storage Systems (BESS) & Module Operations

SCOPE: 2 PRODUCTION BUILDINGS · 11 SUPERVISORS · 6 TEAM LEADS · 240 TECHNICIANS

Promoted from Quality Engineer to Operations Manager during a rapid production scale-up—built the dashboards, flow, and front-line team structure that carried output to scale.

MODULE OPERATIONS

- ▶ Built the company's first production dashboards—OEE metrics, automated gap analysis, and KPI control charts—enabling real-time visibility and strategic decision-making.
- ▶ Converted subassembly from batch to one-piece flow, **increasing production 41%** and reducing defects 22%; cut equipment downtime 36% in two months through Pareto-driven mitigation plans.
- ▶ Implemented visual management (Kanban boards, Andon lights) and automated performance and attendance tracking—raising workforce accountability and accelerating response to issues.
- ▶ Built and trained a new 40-person third shift from scratch—the plant's highest-performing shift within one month.

EOS ENERGY ENTERPRISES — continued

2023 – 2025

BESS OPERATIONS

- ▶ Grew BESS output from 0.5 to 2.2 units/day—a **340% increase**—via Yamazumi workload balancing, takt alignment, and team-based workflows; reduced rework 66%.
- ▶ Integrated an Andon system with automated data collection and control charts for real-time monitoring of quality, downtime, and production; standardized workflows with 5S, safety stocks, and shadow boards.

Quality Engineer — Battery Energy Storage Systems & Module Operations

- ▶ Engineered a high-efficiency battery testing routine, **reducing cycle times 60%** and lifting overall production throughput.
- ▶ Led defect-reduction initiatives achieving a 30% decrease in scrap defects and fewer downstream quality excursions; automated quality documentation and dashboards for rapid decision support.
- ▶ Obtained ISO 9001 Lead Auditor licensure and spearheaded the internal audit program, aligning operations with international standards.

MESSER AMERICAS — Northeast Region, USA

2022 – 2023

Regional Production Engineer — ASU Bulk, Tonnage & Specialty Industrial Gases

- ▶ Led Six Sigma initiatives boosting Krypton/Xenon production 15%, **adding over \$1M in annual revenue**.
- ▶ Drove 15+ system enhancement projects across regional facilities—cutting annual downtime by 25 days and improving daily output consistency 16%.
- ▶ Streamlined production and delivery through cross-functional collaboration, reducing average lead times by 30 days; managed regional project and expense budgets with disciplined financial oversight.

JOHNSON MATTHEY — Smithfield, PA

2020 – 2022

Production Team Shift Leader II / Process Control Engineer — Clean Air Division

- ▶ Led a high-performing team of six production technicians and a process control engineer—increasing OEE more than **5%** with **zero lost-time or recordable injuries** across all shifts.
- ▶ Reduced cycle time 8% and defects 4% through targeted optimization of an automated diesel-catalyst line; designed a risk management tool cutting downtime 8 minutes per work order.
- ▶ Mentored technicians and embedded lean problem-solving in daily routines—building the data-driven, continuous-improvement culture that anchored the team's performance.

CERTIFICATIONS & EDUCATION

Certified Lean Six Sigma Black Belt (CSSBB)

Six Sigma Global Institute (SSGI)

Certified Lean Six Sigma Green Belt (CSSGB)

Messer Americas, EMBRACE Training Academy

ISO 9001 Lead Auditor

Exemplar Global

Certified ScrumMaster® (CSM)

Scrum Alliance

B.S., Chemical Engineering

West Virginia University — Morgantown, WV

Class of 2020